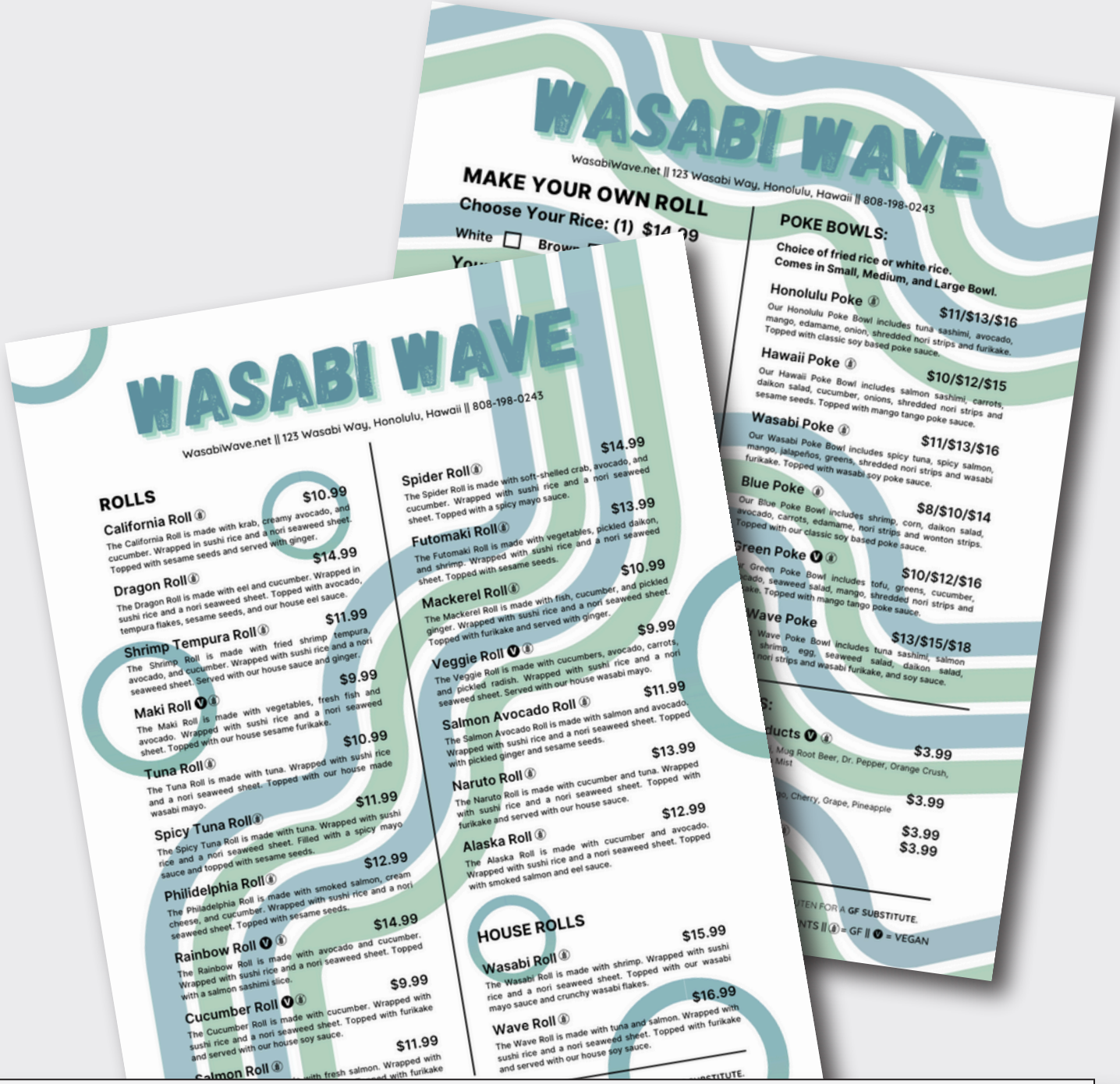


PROMOTIONAL DESIGN

ID: [redacted]

NASHVILLE TN, 2025

TABLE OF CONTENTS

01 Cover Page

02 Table of Contents

03 Interpretation of Theme

04 Description of Items

08 Hardware and Software

09 References

Interpretation of Theme

The theme for this year's promotional design challenge, as stated by tsaweb.org, is "Branding materials for a fictitious restaurant; the four (4) promotional folder items are student choice." After many days of researching and brainstorming the most popular restaurants in Florida and the greater United States, I decided on making the branding materials for a sushi restaurant.

With the rise in popularity of healthy eating and food consciousness becoming more impactful in dining choices and the consistently increasing utilization of social media platforms and their ability to spread trends across a vast global population, more sushi restaurants are opening worldwide now than ever before. Because sushi is made with simple, fresh ingredients including fish, vegetables, seaweed and rice, sushi is a delicious and healthy delicacy that is enjoyed by diners around the world.

The one thing always served with sushi, no matter where in the world you are or what variety you are eating, is wasabi, the deliciously spicy and green horseradish-like paste that tickles your nose and seems to pair best with one type of food alone. A dollop is served with every roll. Almost five million Americans eat sushi at least once a month, so that is over five million dollops of wasabi in just America in one month! Thus, I decided on the "Wasabi" part of the name. I then decided to have this fictitious restaurant located in Honolulu, Hawaii, due to the beautiful nature and close proximity to tons and tons of local fish and farms for access to fresh vegetables, fish, and ingredients. Honolulu is known for its beautiful scenery, but it is also known as the surfing capital of the world. When you think of surfing, you think of waves. Waves also signify trends, so I thought the wave part would suit my sushi restaurant perfectly.

I produced the color palette from inspiration from the colors of the water meeting the sky's horizon on Hawaiian beaches. The green of the restaurant represents comfort and calmness, while the blue represents serenity and peace. These colors, especially when put together, give an inviting, beach-like feel, and I wanted my restaurant to be an inviting and comforting place for people to gather together to enjoy the food we prepared.

For my promotional items, I used two different fonts. The bubble font found on the head of the menu, the flyer, and the business card is called Galagin, which is friendly and inviting and is cohesive with Wasabi Wave's mission. The second is called DM Sans. I used this when I wanted something simple and clean for text that did not need to stand out.

I carried out the theme stated by creating five different cohesive marketing items for Wasabi Wave. After much thought and planning, I ended up making a menu, a flyer that could also be used as a social media post, a poster, a business card, and a coupon card. My aim for them is to reach as large an audience as possible. I demonstrate this in the promotional packet with marketing items that reach a wide audience and age range. This guarantees that the news of a restaurant which caters to everyone would be spread to as many people as possible through various social networks.

Description of Items

MENU:

The menu that I made for my fake restaurant consists of 17 of the most popular sushi rolls from around the world, as well as two rolls that are specific to the restaurant. The menu also includes a "Build Your Own Roll" section. This addition allows customers to create a sushi roll specific to their own liking and expands the options to almost 900 possible combinations. This ensures that every customer will find something that they like. The menu also features a poke bowl section that offers six different, healthy bowl combinations. My intention of using the different combinations is so Wasabi Wave reaches everyone's appetite, despite food sensitive allergies or food preferences. There is a selection of desserts and drinks offered on the menu as well.

The intended audience for this item is more geared towards the health-conscious eaters who enjoy different cuisines. This is due to the healthier, fresh ingredients and little to no sugar approach that the restaurant takes. This would attract a wide-variety of the population due to the impact our rising social media culture has on influencing our population to strive to be healthier.

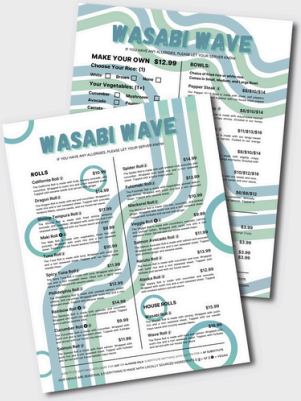
The purpose of this item is to inform customers about the food options at Wasabi Wave. The menu provides health information, promotes sales, and informs customers of what the restaurant offers. This item shows customers what they can order and how much it will cost. This menu also provides information about what exactly is in each dish. Because the menu is posted on the restaurant's website, the customer can see what the Wasabi Wave menu offers before coming into the establishment.

The process for creating this item was simple. First, I researched what the most popular sushi rolls were in the United States and selected the top ones. I then decided what else would be seen on the menu and planned out how it would look. I made the graphics on Adobe illustrator and then uploaded them to Canva to add the text. I made sure everything was evenly spaced out, and easy to read. Next, I had a few people look at it to ensure that the language was comprehensible. Last, I had it printed on cardstock.

However, when I put all of the different items together, something about the color palate was off. I realized that the colors were too dark, making the black text hard to read. My solution was to take the same colors and dim them down. I finished this and reprinted it. Finally, I decided to laminate it to give it the feel of an actual restaurant.

FRONT OF MENU:

MENU:



BACK OF MENU:

FLYER:

The flyer that I made for Wasabi Wave promotes a new, social event that Wasabi Wave is hosting to attract new customers. The flyer includes information about the event. On the back there is a QR code that customers can scan to get to the landing page on our website for Wasabi Wave's sushi social. Here they can find out more information about the event.

I designed this flyer with two uses and intended audiences in mind. The flyer would be printed and handed out to the local community members at community events, and it would also be uploaded and shared digitally on Wasabi Wave's various social media platforms. My intended audience for this item is for both the older population and the younger one as well. Seeing as older generations do not tend to utilize social media as much as younger generations, this flyer will appeal more to them when it is handed out to them as a physical copy. Simultaneously, Wasabi Wave would post the flyer on their social media platforms, which would draw in younger customers as well.

The purpose of this flyer and event are to attract new customers who become returning customers. Live music and a social meetup entice people of all ages. Likewise, sushi is enjoyed by both the young and the old. By combining these, we provide a space to offer a great monthly event that is sure to bring the community together. While doing this, we also promote the Wasabi Wave brand and restaurant. This kind of event will attract new customers who will come, enjoy their time, go home, tell their friends and neighbors, and return to Wasabi Wave.

The process for making this promotional item consisted of a chain of steps. I looked at different flyers I received in the mail, at events, and so on. I confirmed they all shared three main goals: to inform, to promote and to attract customers. I thought a sushi social event with live music would be a great way to attract customers and promote Wasabi Wave's brand. To make the flyer, I used sample clip arts from the internet for a reference to make my own sushi clip art. Next, I added the information in a clear way for viewers to gather the important information they needed. Finally, I printed this item on heavy cardstock.

POSTER:

My next marketing item for my fake restaurant is a poster. This poster would be hung up. Whether hung up on advertisement bulletin boards, outside the restaurant, inside of schools, or inside of office spaces, the number of places this poster can be placed is what makes it so versatile. This poster has a QR code that links to the restaurant's website. When a customer scans this, they can browse the menu, order food, and see other helpful information about the restaurant.

The intended audience of this item is the younger to 65ish aged populations. This is because research has shown that most people over the age of 65 don't know how to scan a QR code or have trouble scanning them. Thus, this item is more geared to younger people.

The purpose of this item is to inform customers of menu offerings and further draw them into visiting the restaurant. This poster will give consumers the ability to see where the restaurant is located, to look at the menu the restaurant has to offer, and by following the QR code that links to the website, they would even have the ability to order food.

The process for making this promotional item took a while. For the regional competition, I had made a poster that looked like a newspaper clipping. While the judges did like it, their feedback was that it did not match the rest of the promotional items. So I spent a lot of time trying to figure out what to do instead. Finally, I landed on the QR code idea. For this item, I used the same clip art that I had used for the folder and the menu. I found a website that makes QR codes and added that image. I printed this item on heavy cardstock.

BUSINESS CARD:

The business card that I made for my contrived restaurant is very simple, yet modern. The goal when making this card was to be as functional as possible, without taking away the aesthetic. I implemented the use of a QR code to the front of the card (it actually works). When scanned, it links to the restaurant's website. It lays out all of the vital information that makes a good business card. The design of this card that I made combines simplicity and functionality to make the perfect balance.

The intended audience of this promotional item is the middle-aged population. While the young people rely on an online presence and the older people have their flyers, the middle-aged population statistically loves business cards. This is because they give a personal touch to exchanging information, thus what this card does.

The purpose of this item is to inform people of what number they can call to get information and/or make reservations, where they can email, and where they can find the restaurant online. The business card includes Wasabi Wave's address, phone number, and a QR code which links to the restaurant's website. It displays all this information in a simple way that is easy to understand.

The process of making this promotional item took longer than the rest, even though it is so small. I first made the logo on Adobe Illustrator. I made the graphics at the same time and used some of the same graphics I made for the poster, flyer, and folder. Then I researched what is needed on a business card and planned what would be displayed on it. I then used the same website that I had used for the poster to make the QR code, and put this on the card, and finished the final draft. I printed this item on thick cardstock to give it the feeling of a business card that an actual company would give out.

COUPON CARD:

The coupon card that I made for my fake restaurant is Christmas themed. When I was doing my research, I found out that over 75% of Honolulu's population is Christian and thus celebrates Christmas. So, I decided to base the coupon card around this holiday. I was therefore not only attempting to draw in more customers to the restaurant, but I also was giving back to the community. I strongly believe more restaurants around the world, especially the really big restaurants and chains, need to give back more to their communities.

The intended audience for this promotional item is anyone and everyone. Everyone likes coupons, so hypothetically, this item should appeal to everyone who receives it. The coupon card would be shipped out to previous customers on the Island, as well as other locals near the restaurant.

The purpose of this item is to draw people into the restaurant through the use of money off their purchase. Statistically speaking, over 70% of people around the world make purchases they didn't originally plan to make because they got a coupon. Thus, even though thirty percent off would not have a profound effect on restaurant profits, more people would definitely be drawn to the restaurant because of it.

The process of making this promotional item consisted of a few steps. I first found the bigger clip art items that I was going to use on Canva. I then used Adobe Illustrator to make the additional items I needed for the coupon card. Then putting it all onto Canva, I added the words and finished the final draft. I printed this item on heavy weight card stock and cut it out.

FRONT OF FLYER:

FLYER:

BACK OF FLYER:

FRONT OF POSTER:

POSTER:

FRONT OF COUPON CARD:

COUPON CARD:

BACK OF COUPON CARD:

FRONT OF BUSINESS CARD:

BUSINESS CARD:

BACK OF BUSINESS CARD:

Hardware and Software

For this project I used;

"Adobe Acrobat a Complete PDF Solution | Adobe Acrobat." *Adobe.com*, 2025, www.adobe.com/acrobat/complete-pdf-solution.html?mv=search&ttid=annual-pro&ef_id=Cj0KCQjw097CBhDIARIsAJ3-nxd08wIfVTjebWZUnUyEQxK_FAMFJShE2SX4SdHsnFbdaOpWratRwF8aAilkEALw_wcB:G:s&s_kwcid=AL.

Canva. "Canva." *Canva*, 2025, www.canva.com.

"Industry-Leading Vector Graphics Software | Adobe Illustrator." *Adobe.com*, 2025, www.adobe.com/products/illustrator/campaign/pricing.html?sdid=ZFN4FBV5&mv=search&mv2=paidsearch&ef_id=Cj0KCQjw097CBhDIARIsAJ3-nxcMcU86lCBofCYovEbGYXiRbrCRlAPBbSRTn0WEHalXc6v4lqwetd4aAj3lEALw_wcB:G:s&s_kwcid=AL.

Microsoft. "Microsoft - Official Home Page." *Microsoft.com*, 2024, www.microsoft.com/en-us/.

"Transform Photos and Make Gorgeous Graphics | Adobe Photoshop." *Adobe.com*, 2025, www.adobe.com/products/photoshop/landpa.html?sdid=NC5FRF5H&mv=search&mv2=paidsearch&ef_id=Cj0KCQjw097CBhDIARIsAJ3-nxfmgE6YxLOYcuBNScdAS9HEs0LOe1v703xHKM0031Ft8a8rxfkGykEaApYFEALw_wcB:G:s&s_kwcid=AL.

References and Clipart

- The sushi clip art on the Flyer was found on Adobe Stock.
- The reindeer clip art on the Coupon Card was found on Adobe Stock.
  - Adobe Stock is a copyright free image source.
- The photos on the folder are from Unsplash.
  - Unsplash is a copyright free image source.

- **All other clip art was made by me.**

"20+ Attention-Grabbing Event Poster Templates, Backgrounds & Design Tips - Venngage." *Venngage*, 17 Oct. 2018, venngage.com/blog/templates-event-poster/.

Format Team. "How to Make a Poster Eye-Catching and Effective." *Www.format.com*, 1 Sept. 2021, www.format.com/magazine/resources/design/how-to-make-a-poster.

"MICHELIN Restaurants – the MICHELIN Guide." *MICHELIN Guide*, 2025, guide.michelin.com/us/en/restaurants/sushi.

pauleijsermans. "What Makes a Good Business Card? 10 Golden Rules." *Vistaprint Ideas and Advice US*, Vistaprint Blog: Small Business Ideas & Advice from Experts, 14 July 2021, www.vistaprint.com/hub/business-card-design-rules?srsltid=AfmBOorV51uwTOpfi6mSzxLUxcpbTYwYPMJvbAcWXPrFNoMYBNq7id_q.

rihabbenlaaribi. "The 50 Best Promotional Products & Trends | 2025 VistaPrint Study." *Vistaprint Ideas and Advice US*, Vistaprint Blog: Small Business Ideas & Advice from Experts, 8 May 2025, www.vistaprint.com/hub/top-promotional-products-and-trends?srsltid=AfmBOooy-QgnpB-habXDQFUbZfQUMy8b1eQoIEpSy-XFl-aSHLOeJ7Xx.